

happen, it will be after the Los Angeles [Olympics]. But I really don't like the training. It's not the race — it's the training. That's the hard part.

What's your favourite part about the 100m?

I think the 100m is more of a glory race. As my brother would put it, it's about being the show pony as opposed to being the workhorse. It has all the glitz and glam, all the excitement and fireworks. But of course, with that also comes the hard part: when you're not on top, it really sucks.

How do you cope with that?

I see losing as part of the journey. It's a lot more fun when you have one or two losses, because then you get to say, 'OK, this is where I need to get better. This is how I'm going to improve. I'm going to give it my all. I'm going to lock in.' Sometimes, when you're winning too often, you get a little complacent.

Whether you're trying your best or not, it's hard to constantly push yourself on your own. It's almost like in a story — you need to lose to have character development. That's exactly how I see it.

This year, you were nominated for another World

Athlete of the Year award, but Mondo [Duplantis] won it. Do you ever think it's harder for you to win these awards because you need to do well in more events?

Um, I don't know. There's a lot more politics to these awards than you think. I don't think Mondo doesn't deserve Athlete of the Year — I mean he breaks the world record every year.

Personally, I didn't even think I

was going to get nominated this year. I started out and then got injured midway through the season. I had some great 200m times. It wasn't until they nominated me and I actually looked at my season that I realised, 'Wow, that wasn't too bad. Why wouldn't I get nominated?'

But the World Athlete of the Year thing is kind of redundant. I mean, Melissa [Jefferson-Wooden, who swept gold in the 100m, 200m and 4x100m at the 2025 World Athletics Championships] wasn't even nominated. At this point, the award is kind of a joke.

You have this aura of confidence around you. Does that follow you in everything you do in life?

There's plenty I'm insecure about. Just don't ask me to read. I have dyslexia, so reading was never one of my strong suits.

Spelling too — don't ask me to spell either. Reading and spelling were definitely not among the more fun things for me to do. Right now, you are looking at the finished product, something that's taken a lot of growth over many years. For most of my childhood, confidence was the

EMMANUEL YIGINI

